PATRICIA CUELLAR

Financial Analyst | Corporate Finance | Financial Reporting & Analysis
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Finance and FP&A professional with extensive corporate financial analysis experience, including direct support for practice group financial performance, attorney compensation committee coordination, cost center analysis, and executive reporting for a mid-size Am Law 200 firm. Deep expertise in financial report development, spreadsheet modeling (advanced Excel: VLOOKUP, PivotTables), budget vs. actual analysis, variance reporting, and cross-functional collaboration with attorneys, staff departments, and firm leadership. Experienced in billing, budgeting systems, and Power BI. Committed to continuous professional development — CompTIA Data+ certified (2026).

CORE COMPETENCIES

Financial Reporting & Analysis • FP&A & Budget Management • Financial Report Development & Presentation • Budget vs. Actual & Variance Analysis • Spreadsheet Modeling & Data Analysis • Compensation Committee Support • Project Coordination & Multi-Initiative Management • Cross-Functional Stakeholder Communication • Process Improvement & Standardization • Bilingual English / Spanish

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Finance Systems: Elite Legal Billing | Oracle | Forecaster | Data Fusion | FRx Financial Reporting | Siebel | Maxcim
Analytics & Reporting: Microsoft Excel (advanced: PivotTables, VLOOKUP, XLOOKUP, nested IF, data modeling) | Power BI (coursework, 2026) | Tableau (coursework, 2019) | Crystal Reports | Discoverer Reports | Data Warehouse
AI & Productivity Tools: Claude — regular use for financial analysis support, narrative drafting, and research | ChatGPT | Google Gemini | Microsoft Office Suite (Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Financial Analyst

Dickstein Shapiro LLP — Am Law 200 | Washington, DC
August 2005 – March 2016

- Served as lead FP&A analyst for a $200M+ annual budget cycle, supporting the CFO across all phases: budget formulation, execution, monitoring, and variance reporting for all staff departments and practice group cost centers.
- Developed financial reports and analyses highlighting practice group performance related to budgets, revenue activity, billing rates, and cost center trends — delivered monthly to the CFO and senior leadership as decision-ready financial packages.
- Supported the firm's non-partner attorney compensation committee by coordinating financial and headcount data, providing analytical support for compensation reviews and workforce planning decisions.
- Performed matter-level financial analysis for contingency cases, producing ad hoc reports and financial summaries that supported attorney and leadership decision-making at the client and matter level.
- Analyzed and communicated financial results to both internal stakeholders — attorneys, practice group leaders, and staff department heads — translating complex financial data into clear, actionable summaries for non-finance audiences.
- Extracted, consolidated, and analyzed large data sets from Elite legal billing system and Data Fusion to fulfill financial reporting assignments, identify performance drivers, and support ad hoc requests.
- Built and maintained spreadsheets and financial models including budget templates, forecasting tools, and standard hours tracking, using advanced Excel (PivotTables, VLOOKUP, IF formulas); designed standardized frameworks adopted firm-wide.
- Led bi-annual forecasting cycles, coordinating multi-round submissions from Chief Officers, Directors, and department managers; updated forecast models to pull from live Data Fusion data, improving accuracy and timeliness.
- Conducted billing rate and salary benchmarking using PwC BRASS, Wells Fargo, Citibank, and Am Law surveys; managed BEA, Capital Expenditures, and census survey submissions; synthesized findings into leadership-ready reports.
- Coordinated across HR, marketing, technology, operations, and finance on multiple concurrent projects and reporting initiatives, managing competing deadlines and priorities in a fast-paced law firm environment.
- Maintained firmwide headcount, FTE, standard hours, and attrition reporting; produced monthly cost center expense reports and supported workforce planning and position-level analysis.
- Selected for LAMP and LEAD firm-wide leadership development programs; founded the Finance Department Events Committee.

Financial Analyst

Merkle Inc. | Columbia, MD
July 2003 – August 2005

- Coordinated and consolidated a $65M annual budget across multiple subsidiaries; managed quarterly forecasting and prepared executive financial reporting packages for senior leadership.
- Delivered ad hoc profitability, variance, and cost analyses to support business planning. Oversaw contracts payable, reconciled key accounts, and maintained financial data accuracy across reporting systems.

Earlier career: Financial analysis roles at Hughes Network Systems ($120M project portfolios, $17M R&D budget, $5.8M capital budget tracking), Digex/MCI WorldCom (revenue assurance), NET.COM (worldwide sales reporting), and ExecuStay/Manugistics (contract analysis, Oracle).

INDEPENDENT EXPERIENCE | 2016 – 2026

Independent Real Estate & Financial Manager | Self-Directed | *Potomac, MD | 2016–2020*

- Managed budgeting, expense tracking, cash flow, P&L recordkeeping, and financial oversight for a four-property residential rental portfolio; coordinated contractors and partnered with a real estate agent on the strategic sale of all four properties.

Community & Volunteer Leadership | Manna, So What Else, I Support the Girls | *2016–Present*

- Ongoing nonprofit volunteer service in the Washington, DC metro area; school and youth sports volunteer leadership for 10+ years.

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- CompTIA Data+ | Earned 2026 (Valid through April 2029)
- Power BI Training | Montgomery College | 2026
- Data Analysis Certificate (including Tableau) | Montgomery College | 2019

EDUCATION

University of Maryland — College Park, MD

- B.S., Finance | B.S., Accounting | B.S., International Business